

Poco C51

Premium design on a budget

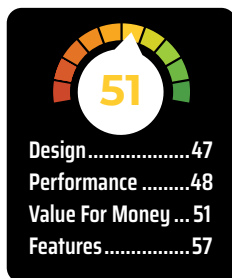
The latest entry-level offering from POCO, the POCO C51 launched in India at a price of Rs 7,799, and is available for purchase on Flipkart. This puts the smartphone in competition with the likes of the recently-launched sibling, the Redmi 12C, the Indian-made Lava Yuva 2 Pro, and more such offerings. While there are clearly many latest options, the POCO C51 has something about it. So what is it about this smartphone that makes it seem more premium than others? Let's talk about it.

DESIGN

The major factor that sets the POCO C51 apart from its rivals is the smartphone's design. The polycarbonate back panel is what makes all the difference. We get a leather-like texture on the back, similar to what we saw on the Redmi A1 series last year. This gives a nice in-hand feel to the POCO C51. Other things include a dual-tone camera module, which is placed in the top left corner of the back panel. There is a water-drop notch on the POCO C51, and the bezels are thicker than what we are used to seeing from smartphones in 2023. The size of the smartphone is not too big or too small. Overall, this is a good design approach from POCO.

DISPLAY

Display on the POCO C51 is not very crisp or sharp. We get 269ppi pixel density, which does not amount to a lot of detail in the display. The colours also seem a bit dull, and this display doesn't feel very vibrant from the get-go. We also don't get a high refresh rate, so it also lacks responsiveness. The brightness is also not all that great. The smartphone showed a maximum typical brightness of 361 nits, and a minimum of 3 nits.



While these aren't the best numbers, I was able to use the smartphone under all kinds of conditions comfortably, without any issues with visibility. Overall, while the display is underwhelming, it is at par with the competition.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, if you are coming from a mid-range or a flagship smartphone, this will feel slow. However, pitting the POCO C51 against its rivals, the smartphone isn't too far behind. In CPU-based benchmarks, we got a score of 104,163 points on AnTuTu and 4,731 points on PCMark. In GPU-based benchmarks the smartphone scored 318.50 in the Aztec Ruins High Tier Benchmark, 337.1 points in GFXBench Car Chase, and 857 points in GFXBench Manhattan 3.1 test. This basically shows the smartphone's gaming capabilities. Now, despite the numbers not being too big, the POCO C51 is still capable of running games like Call of Duty: Mobile easily. I did experience lags and frame drops a few times, but I did manage to

win a few rounds, meaning this kind of performance is enough for casual gaming. One the POCO C51, with the Android Go version, the experience is streamlined.

BATTERY

The battery backup on this device is good. I was easily able to make this last for more than 1.5 days, despite gaming and running benchmarks on the device. Overall, it gave an on-screen time of more than 7 hours, which is great! The POCO C51 charged from 0 to 100 in more than 2.5 hours! That is quite slow if compared with 2023 standards.

CAMERA

Photos from the POCO C51 are just okay. In ideal lighting conditions, we can manage to get very good shots from this camera. However, in low light conditions, this device struggles. The images in low light are a bit hazy and lack detail. Further, there is no wide-angle or telephoto lens for users to play around with.

VERDICT

For a budget of around Rs 8,000, the POCO C51 is a good device to go for, if you want a smooth Android experience without any premium features. You get a very attractive design that actually looks and feels premium, you get enough performance to run all your high-power games, and you get enough battery that will last a long time. However, the display is underwhelming, and you only get 10W fast charging via a micro-USB port. The camera is also not all that bad, and you get a few more convenience features like a capacitive fingerprint sensor at the back and a 3.5mm headphone jack.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Helio G36 | Memory and Storage: 4GB+64GB | Display: 6.52" HD+ Display | Camera: 8MP AI Dual Camera, f/2.0 | Front Camera: 5MP, f/2.0 | Battery and Charging: 5000mAh (typ) Lithium-ion polymer, 10W Charging | Network: LTE

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